The Bodybuilder's Core Academy

SHOW DAY PLAYBOOK

Your core plan for the weeks before the show, all the way to the moment you walk out.



RELAXATION IS THE KEY

Show weekends are crazy. This is a guide, so if you don't get to all of it, don't worry! The last thing you want is to stress that you didn't release your diaphragm and end up tighter.

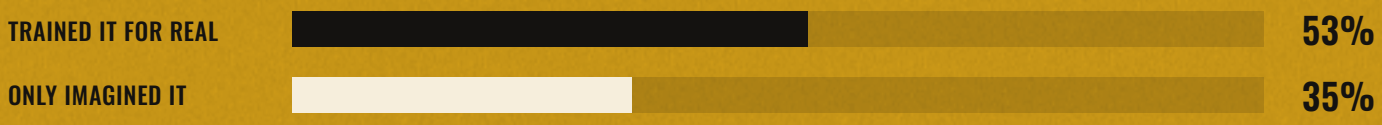
EVERY DAY, WEEKS BEFORE

VISUALIZE YOUR STAGE CORE

Close your eyes for a few minutes every day and rehearse your stage core. Picture yourself walking out and hitting your front pose.

Feel it as if you're actually doing it: the small inhale, the exhale, growing tall, soft ribs, how your core feels while you hold. Keep it going right through show week and the night before.

WHY FEELING IT MATTERS



Strength gained in 12 weeks. People who only imagined hard little finger contractions got most of the way there. A 2013 follow up found the gains came when people imagined from the inside, feeling the movement, and not when they watched themselves like a video.

Ranganathan et al. 2004, Neuropsychologia · Yao et al. 2013, Frontiers in Human Neuroscience

LEADING UP TO THE SHOW

UP TO 15 MINUTES OF LPF A DAY

In the lead up to your show, do up to 15 minutes of LPF a day. The 10 minute flows are great too. They're short on purpose, so they fit around everything else you have going on.

10 MINUTE LPF FLOWS

DAY BEFORE

LONG HOLDS LONG EXHALES

Do your LPF and put your focus on longer vacuum holds and longer exhales. Slow, drawn out exhales help calm your nervous system, which is exactly what you want the day before you step on stage. Keep it easy.

10 MINUTE LPF FLOWS

SHOW MORNING

RELEASE, MOVE CONNECT

Start with a release, done over your robe or shirt. **Careful with the tan!**



FINGERTIP RELEASE. No rubbing. Slide your fingertips under the edge of your rib cage and just breathe.



BALL RELEASE IN CHILD'S POSE. Ball on your lap, then sink into child's pose and breathe. Didn't bring your ball? Use a hotel cushion instead.

DEEP FINGERTIP RELEASE

BALL RELEASE IN CHILD'S POSE

NO STATIC STRETCHING TODAY

Move instead, with a few gentle reps of each from Posing Mobility.



OPEN BOOK AND SWEEP. Lie on your side, knees bent and stacked, arms straight out in front. Open your top arm across to the other side and follow it with your eyes, then sweep it overhead and back to start.



CAT COW. On hands and knees, round your spine up one section at a time, then slowly arch it the other way.



90/90 HIP SWITCHES. Sit with both knees bent to 90, one in front and one to the side. Rotate both knees over to the other side and back.

OPEN BOOK AND SWEEP | CAT COW | 90/90 HIP SWITCHES

5 VACUUMS, 3 BREATHS BETWEEN, ABOUT 5 MINUTES

Keep the holds smooth and easy. You're just finding the connection.

STRINGING YOUR VACUUMS TOGETHER

FEELING BACKED UP?

Try any of the tabletop positions, especially forearms down and diamond hands. Work on releasing your pelvic floor by inhaling into it and letting it recoil. Soft ribs on the exhale.

Do your before bed breathing exercises too. A tight pelvic floor can make constipation worse, and so can stress, since it keeps your body in fight or flight mode. Long exhales help calm that down.



FOREARMS DOWN



FOREHEAD DOWN

TABLETOP ON FOREARMS | TABLETOP, FOREHEAD DOWN

MAKEUP CHAIR

SIT TALL
AND BREATHE

Sit nice and tall and practice your 360 breathing, letting each inhale widen your ribs front, sides and back.

If you have a chance, run through your visualization, or use this time to chat with the other athletes and your makeup artist. Sometimes taking your mind off the show helps stage nerves more than anything!

Stay off your phone and social media as much as you can and look around, because out of everyone in the world, very few people ever get to have this one of a kind experience.

360 BREATHING | BREATHING TIMER

THE BREATHING TIMER COMES FROM THE STAGE CORE CUSTOM PROGRAM.

BACKSTAGE

FEET UP
EXHALE LONG

Find a spot, lie down and put your feet up on something. Relax and focus on long exhales.

2 OR 3 LYING VACUUMS BEFORE YOU'RE CALLED

Long, gentle holds, just reconnecting.



FEET ON THE WALL BREATHING

ON STAGE

LOCKED CORE
THE VACUUM STAYS BACKSTAGE

SMALL INHALE, EXHALE, GROW, SOFT RIBS

FROM ME TO YOU

WALK OUT LIKE YOU BELONG

I've done this for years. Prep, show, repeat. So if I can leave you with one thing today, it's this. Whatever you're feeling right now, I know. Maybe it's excitement, maybe it's nerves, maybe it's both.

Hundreds of thousands of people have stood where you're standing, and hundreds of thousands more will stand there after you. It might feel like you're the only one carrying this much excitement and this many nerves. You're not. Every one of them felt it too, and every one of them still walked out on that stage.

You're also part of one of the most supportive communities out there. I have never met a group of people who cheer each other on the way athletes do.

You've done absolutely everything to get here. You're part of The Bodybuilder's Core Academy, which tells me you're not someone who does the bare minimum. Confidence comes from trusting the work you've put in. So step on that stage like you belong there, because you do. Your energy speaks louder than anything else you bring out there. Smile, hold your head up high, and be proud of what you're capable of.

Now, with love: it's really not that serious. For most of us this isn't our career, and it isn't our family. Right now it feels like the whole world, but this one day won't define the rest of your life. So when you walk out, put yourself in a bubble. Just you and this moment, with the past, the future and whoever is standing next to you left outside of it.

Before you walk off, take one second to look out at the crowd and soak it in. You earned that. Then let the placing be whatever it is. If you've persevered through an entire prep while juggling everything else in your life, you've already won.

One day you'll decide not to compete anymore, and you'll miss it in a way you can't imagine right now. So spend the day taking it all in.

If you need any support during show week, reach out to your fellow competitors here in BCA. We are all here for you.

With love,
DOVE